

AFCAT Solved Paper-II 2025

(Held on 23 Aug 2025 Shift-1)

Verbal Ability in English

1. Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words:

A person who has both introvert and extrovert qualities.

- (a) Philanthropist (b) Ambivert
(c) Altruist (d) Misanthrope

2. Choose the word which is most opposite in meaning to "Malevolent".

- (a) Vindictive (b) Benevolent
(c) Spiteful (d) Malicious

3. Choose the option that best explains the meaning of the idiom:

"To take/carry coal to Newcastle"

- (a) To engage in a profitable business
(b) To do something superfluous or unnecessary
(c) To take risk in a dangerous place
(d) To supply a scarce commodity

4. Choose the option that best explains the meaning of the idiom:

"To throw up the sponge"

- (a) To surrender or give up a contest
(b) To insult an opponent
(c) To hide one's true feelings
(d) To celebrate a victory

5. Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words:

A person who is fearless and adventurous is called –

- (a) Pusillanimous (b) Intrepid
(c) Timorous (d) Diffident

6. Choose the word which is the most appropriate synonym of "Quash".

- (a) Perpetuate (b) Nullify
(c) Substantiate (d) Endorse

7. Spot the error in the following sentence:

The two (A)/ brother in laws (B)/ attended the wedding ceremony together. (C)/ No error (D)

- (a) A (b) B
(c) C (d) D

8. Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words:

An act of violating or showing disrespect towards something sacred or holy is called–

- (a) Heresy (b) Sacrilege
(c) Discrimination (d) Defamation

9. Choose the synonym of "Cognoscenti"

- (a) Connoisseurs (b) Novices
(c) Laymen (d) Amateurs

10. Choose the word which is the most appropriate synonym of "Reckless".

- (a) Rash (b) Prudent
(c) Circumspect (d) Wary

Directions (11-15): Read the following passage and answer the given questions.

The concept of zero, often taken for granted in modern mathematics, is a relatively recent intellectual achievement in the long history of human civilization. While ancient cultures like the Babylonians used a placeholder symbol to indicate an empty position in their sexagesimal system, this was not equivalent to our modern notion of zero as a number. The true mathematical zero, representing both "nothingness" and functioning as an independent number with arithmetic properties, was first developed in India around the 5th century CE.

The Indian scholar Brahmagupta formalized rules for arithmetic involving zero, including addition, subtraction, and multiplication, though he struggled with division by zero.

From India, the idea spread to the Islamic world, where scholars translated and expanded upon Indian texts, integrating zero into the Arabic numeral system. The Arabic term "sifr," meaning empty, eventually evolved into the word "zero" in European languages. By the 12th century, with the translation of Arabic mathematical works into Latin, zero entered European thought, profoundly transforming mathematics, commerce, and science.

Zero's adoption met resistance in Europe; it was considered mysterious and even dangerous, partly because it was linked to Arabic culture and partly because its abstraction defied common sense. Yet, once fully accepted, zero became indispensable, enabling advancements in algebra, calculus, and eventually, modern computing. Thus, what began as a humble placeholder evolved into a cornerstone of human intellectual progress.

11. The Babylonians' use of zero was primarily as:

- (a) A true number with independent value
(b) A placeholder in positional notation
(c) A symbol of infinity
(d) A representation of division by zero

12. Who is credited with formalizing the arithmetic rules of zero?

- (a) Aryabhata (b) Euclid
(c) Brahmagupta (d) Al-Khwarizmi

13. The word "zero" in European languages evolved from:

- (a) Latin "nihil"
(b) Greek "kenon"
(c) Arabic "sifr"
(d) Sanskrit "shunya"

14. Resistance to zero in medieval Europe was due to:

- (a) Lack of translation of Indian texts
(b) Its association with Arabic culture and abstract nature
(c) Its inability to be used in multiplication
(d) The prohibition of symbols in mathematics

15. According to the passage, zero's acceptance was crucial in the advancement of:

- (a) Geometry and Trigonometry
(b) Algebra, Calculus, and Computing
(c) Astronomy and Architecture
(d) Literature and Philosophy

Directions (16-18) Read the following passage and answer the given questions.

The following question consists of an incomplete sentence or a sentence which is split into four parts. All four parts are jumbled up and are named as P, Q, R and S. These four parts are not given in their proper order. Arrange the jumbled parts of the sentence and find out which of the four combinations from the given options will correctly complete the sentence.

16. India has been a land _____
than the warrior or the administrator.
P: but in the sense that learning has always been very highly valued
Q: not indeed, in the sense that education has been universal

R: and the learned man has been held in higher esteem

S: of learning throughout the ages,

- (a) SPRQ (b) RQPS
(c) RSQP (d) SQPR

17. While the recent _____.

P: century show that the June rainfall is

Q: of a drought, India's rainfall data for over a

R: rain may have soothed concerns

S: no predictor of the monsoon's outcome

- (a) PSRQ (b) RQPS
(c) PQRS (d) RSPQ

18. For some people patriotism _____ as much as to any one country.

P: today man belongs to the whole world

Q: should be condemned because

R: type of patriotism is an evil and it

S: means hatred for other countries, but this

- (a) SRQP (b) PQSR
(c) RSPQ (d) QPSR

Directions (19-21): Read the following passage and answer the given questions.

In the following question, there is a related pair of words given. Each pair is followed by four other pairs of words. Choose the pair from the given option that best expresses the relationship like the original pair.

19. Bee : Honey :: Cow : _____

- (a) Grass (b) Milk
(c) Horns (d) Farm

20. Oven : Bake :: Knife : _____

- (a) Slice (b) Cook
(c) Kitchen (d) Heat

21. Finger : Hand :: Leaf : _____

- (a) Plant (b) Branch
(c) Tree (d) Flower

Directions (22-24): Read the following passage and answer the given questions.

Each item in this section has a sentence with three parts (A), (B), and (C). Read each sentence to find out whether there is any error in any underlined part and indicate your response on the answer sheet against the corresponding letter, i.e., (A) or (B) or (C). If you find no error, your response should be indicated as (D).

22. Ten kilometers (A)/ are a long distance (B)/ to walk on foot. (C)/ No error (D)

- (a) A (b) B
(c) C (d) D

23. Neither of the students (A)/ have completed (B)/ the assignment yet. (C)/ No error (D)

- (a) A (b) B
(c) C (d) D

24. She did not know (A)/ to whom should she (B)/ address the letter. (C)/ No error (D)

- (a) A (b) B
(c) C (d) D

Directions (25-27): Each of the following sentences in this section has a blank space and four words are given after the sentence. Select whichever word you consider most appropriate for the blank space and indicate your response on the Answer Sheet accordingly.

25. The judge remained completely _____ while giving his verdict.

- (a) impartial (b) biased
(c) emotional (d) hesitant

26. Hardly _____ the train left the platform when it began to rain heavily.

- (a) has (b) will
(c) had (d) does

27. During his visit to the museum, he _____ some rare paintings of the Mughal period.

- (a) came across (b) came by
(c) came out (d) came into

Directions (28-30): Read the following passage and answer the given questions in the blanks given in the passage with a proper words:

Most of our food comes from agriculture, so we tend to believe that it is independent of natural biota. This is not true. In nature, both plants and animals _____ (1) _____ to the rigours of natural selection. Only the fittest survive.

Consequently, wild populations have numerous traits for competitiveness, resistance to parasites, _____ (2) _____ to adverse conditions, and other aspects of vigour. In contrast, populations grown for many generations under the pampered conditions of agriculture tend to lose these traits, because they are selected for production, not resilience. For example, a high-producing plant that lacks resistance to drought is _____ (3) _____ and the resistance to drought is ignored. Also, in the process of breeding plants for maximum production, all genetic variation is eliminated.

28. What will come in blank (1)?

- (a) had been continuously subjected
(b) will be continuously subject
(c) continuously subjected
(d) are continuously subjected

29. What will come in blank (2)?

- (a) withdrawal
(b) tolerance
(c) adaptable
(d) compliance

30. What will come in blank (3)?

- (a) heated (b) irrigated
(c) showered (d) deserted

General Awareness

31. The languages used in the inscriptions of Ashoka is:

- (a) Sanskrit (b) Prakrit
(c) Pali (d) Hindi

32. Consider the following statements regarding the Nidhi Scheme:

1. The scheme was launched in 2014 by the Ministry of Human Resource Development.
2. It aims to support higher education institutions to set up start-ups through incubation and innovation.
3. The full form of NIDHI is National Initiative for Developing and Harnessing Innovations.
4. The scheme is implemented by the Department of Science & Technology.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1, 3 and 4
(c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

33. The RailOne App, launched by Indian Railways in 2025, primarily aims to:

- (a) Provide passengers with a single-window platform for integrated services.
(b) Replace the IRCTC e-ticketing website completely.
(c) Facilitate only freight and cargo tracking.
(d) Operate as an exclusive platform for railway staff communication.

34. General Bipin Rawat, the first Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) of India, was commissioned into which regiment of the Indian Army?

- (a) Rajput Regiment (b) Gorkha Rifles
(c) Sikh Regiment (d) Jat Regiment

35. Which of the following is the primary cause of acid rain formation?

- (a) Carbon monoxide emissions
(b) Deforestation
(c) Sulfur dioxide and nitrogen oxides emissions
(d) Ozone depletion

36. Which Indian writer was awarded the International Booker Prize for the year 2025?

- (a) Girish Karnad
(b) Geetanjali Sri
(c) Banu Mushtaq
(d) K. Shivaram Karanth

37. Exercise PRALAY was carried out by which armed force?

- (a) Indian Army
(b) Indian Navy
(c) Indian Air Force
(d) Indian Coast Guard